Northstar Home Policy Wording

POL-HOME-002-v2 | 2.0 | Effective 2025-01-01

Northstar Home Policy

This synthetic wording applies to the insured home shown on the schedule while this version is in force. It must be read with any active endorsements. An endorsement changes this wording only where it says that a clause is replaced, extended, or removed.

1. Buildings and contents

Buildings are the permanent structure, fixtures, and fittings at the insured address. Contents are household belongings kept in the home. The schedule states which sections are insured and the applicable excess.

2. Your responsibilities

You must take reasonable care to prevent loss, keep the home in a reasonable state of repair, and tell us promptly when circumstances materially change. These duties do not remove our obligation to assess the facts of a claim fairly.

3. Escape of water

We cover sudden and accidental loss to insured property caused by water escaping from a fixed domestic water or heating installation, a domestic appliance, or a pipe that supplies the home. The leak must be unintended and occur during the period of insurance.

The cost to repair the failed pipe, appliance, or fitting is not covered unless the schedule or an endorsement expressly says otherwise. We may pay reasonable costs to locate the source of an insured escape of water when those costs are necessary to limit further damage.

4. Flood and surface water

4.1 Meaning of flood

Flood means a temporary covering of normally dry land by water that has escaped or been released from the sea, a river, a canal, a reservoir, or another natural or artificial watercourse. Water entering from surface run-off after intense rain may be treated as flood when it accumulates outside the building before entering.

4.2 Base flood exclusion

Unless an endorsement shown on the schedule adds cover, loss caused by flood is excluded. Water entering through an opening created by flood remains flood damage even if it later reaches the ground floor through an internal drain.

4.3 Gradual seepage exclusion

Loss caused by gradual seepage, repeated leakage, condensation, damp, or water entering over time is excluded. A sudden discovery does not by itself make a long-running leak accidental or sudden.

5. General exclusions

We do not cover wear and tear, defective design, or the cost of correcting faulty workmanship. We will consider resulting physical damage separately where another insured cause is established and no exclusion removes that resulting damage.

6. Making a claim

Tell us as soon as reasonably possible, take reasonable steps to prevent further damage, and keep damaged items available for inspection where safe. We will explain what evidence is reasonably needed and keep you informed of material delays.